JASON CHOI
REAL ESTATE

FREE CHECKLIST

RESTAURANT BUYER'S CHECKLIST

Restaurant Equipment Due Diligence Checklist

Use this checklist with a qualified equipment technician when inspecting a restaurant, café or bar before you remove conditions.



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1. How to Use This Checklist

Walk through the restaurant with a qualified technician. For each item, note its age, give it a condition score, and confirm it is listed on the seller's equipment schedule in the purchase agreement.

Score	Condition	What to do
5	Excellent — like new	Accept. Record make, model and serial number.
4	Good — minor wear, well maintained	Accept with service records.
3	Fair — works, but aging	Ask for a price reduction or seller repair.
2	Poor — needs replacement soon	Ask for a credit or replacement before closing.
1	Failed or unsafe	Exclude it or require replacement.

> **Three questions for every item**
>
> 1. **Is it on the seller's equipment list (schedule) in the agreement?** If not, it may not be included.
> 2. **Is it owned or leased?** Leased items (POS, espresso machines, some refrigeration, dish machines) do not transfer without the leasing company's consent. Ask for payout letters.
> 3. **What would it cost to repair or replace?** For items over 10 years old, get a replacement estimate.

Inspector: use licensed trades (gas fitter, refrigeration mechanic, electrician) as needed. Budget about $500–$1,500 for a full equipment inspection.

2. Ask the Seller for These Before Inspection Day

☐	Document	Notes
☐	Full equipment list with make, model and serial numbers	
☐	Service and maintenance records for the last 3 years	
☐	All equipment leases, rentals and financing contracts	
☐	Warranty documents for equipment still under warranty	
☐	Latest hood cleaning and fire suppression inspection certificates	
☐	Latest grease trap / interceptor service record	
☐	Gas and electricity bills for 12 months	
☐	Public health inspection reports and any outstanding orders	

3. Cooking Equipment

☐	Equipment	Age	Score 1–5	Included Y/N	What to check
☐	Range (6–8 burner)				All burners, igniters, oven seals
☐	Convection oven				Door seals, fan, thermostat
☐	Combi oven / steamer				Service history, scale build-up
☐	Griddle / flat top				Even surface, thermostat
☐	Charbroiler				Burners, grates, gas valve
☐	Fryer(s)				Thermostat, drain valves, oil filtration — safety critical
☐	Salamander / broiler				Burners or elements
☐	Wok range				Burners, water connections
☐	Microwave, toaster, panini press				Function and door seals
☐	Induction cooktop				All zones, fault codes

> **⚠ Gas safety**
> All gas equipment should be checked by a licensed gas fitter before you take over. Confirm connectors, shut-off valves and regulators are safe, and that installations had permits.

4. Refrigeration

☐	Equipment	Age	Score 1–5	Included Y/N	What to check
☐	Walk-in cooler — compressor, fans				Refrigerant, noise, defrost
☐	Walk-in cooler — door, floor, panels				Gaskets, drains, no mould
☐	Walk-in freezer				Compressor, door heater
☐	Reach-in fridges / freezers				Temperature, door seals
☐	Prep table with cold rail				Holds temperature under load
☐	Bar / keg coolers, draft system				Temperature, CO2, lines
☐	Display cases				Temperature, lighting, seals
☐	Ice machine and bin				Production, scale, sanitation

> Food safety rules require cold food at **4°C or colder**, frozen food at about **-18°C**, and hot holding at **60°C or hotter**. Record temperatures during the inspection. Any unit that cannot hold temperature must be fixed before you take over.

5. Prep and Dishwashing

☐	Equipment	Age	Score 1–5	Included Y/N	What to check
☐	Mixer (floor / countertop)				Gears, attachments, speeds
☐	Slicer, grinder, food processor				Blades, guards, motor
☐	Vacuum sealer				Seal quality
☐	Dishwasher (door / conveyor)				Wash and rinse temperatures, spray arms
☐	Glass washer				Cycle, rinse temperature
☐	3-compartment sink, hand sinks				Hot water at all sinks, drains
☐	Grease trap / interceptor				Last pumping record
☐	Chemical dispensing system				Correct chemicals, calibrated

6. Ventilation and Fire Safety

☐	Equipment	Age	Score 1–5	Included Y/N	What to check
☐	Exhaust hood (grease)				Filters, grease troughs, ducts
☐	Exhaust fan (rooftop)				Motor, belt, airflow
☐	Make-up air unit				Matches exhaust, heater works
☐	Hood cleaning certificate				Date of last cleaning (frequency depends on volume)
☐	Fire suppression system				Inspection tag current (usually every 6 months); covers all cooking equipment
☐	Gas shut-off on suppression				Tested by the inspection company

☐	Fire extinguishers	Annual tags; Class K in kitchen
☐	Emergency lights, exit signs	Battery test
☐	Rooftop HVAC / split units	Heating, cooling, filters
☐	Water heater	Capacity at peak, temperature

> **⚠ Non-negotiable**
> An out-of-date fire suppression inspection is a critical problem — fire and health authorities can close a restaurant. If it is not current, require the seller to fix it before closing.

7. Front of House, Bar and Technology

☐	Equipment	Age	Score 1–5	Included Y/N	What to check
☐	Espresso machine, grinders				Often leased — confirm ownership
☐	Draft beer system				Glycol chiller, lines, cleaning log
☐	Tables, chairs, stools				Count and condition
☐	Sound, lighting, patio heaters				Function and safety
☐	POS hardware and software				Owned or leased? Licence transferable?
☐	Payment terminals				Processor agreement
☐	Online ordering accounts				Transfer process, commission rates
☐	Cameras, alarm, Wi-Fi, phone				Contracts and monthly costs

> **Common technology mistakes**
> • Assuming the POS transfers — many are leased or tied to the seller's merchant account.
> • Forgetting monthly subscriptions ($300–$1,200+ per month).
> • Transferring customer or loyalty data without legal advice — privacy laws (PIPA / PIPEDA) apply.
> • Forgetting commercial music licensing.

8. Building Systems

☐	Item	Notes
☐	Electrical service is large enough for all equipment; panel labelled and in good condition	
☐	Gas supply is large enough for all gas equipment; shut-offs accessible	
☐	Enough hot water at peak times	
☐	Floor drains clear; no leaks	
☐	Backflow prevention installed where required	
☐	12 months of utility bills reviewed for unusual use	

9. Summary and Price Allocation

Category	Replacement value	Avg score	Agreed value
Cooking line	$	/5	$
Refrigeration	$	/5	$
Ice machines	$	/5	$
Prep equipment	$	/5	$
Dishwashing and sanitation	$	/5	$
Hood and ventilation	$	/5	$
HVAC	$	/5	$
Bar equipment	$	/5	$
Furniture and fixtures	$	/5	$
POS and technology	$	/5	$
Smallwares	$	/5	$
Inventory (counted at closing — separate)			$
Total	**$**		**$**

How the price is split between equipment, goodwill and inventory affects taxes for both sides. **Your accountant should review the allocation before you sign.**

Buying a restaurant?
Call or text **(403) 399-8124**, email **CalgaryJason@gmail.com**, or visit **jasonchoirealestate.com**. English and 한국어.

This checklist is for general information and organization only. It is not an equipment, engineering, fire-safety or legal inspection or advice. Use licensed technicians and get advice from your lawyer and accountant. Prepared by Jason Choi, REALTOR®, First Place Realty. Updated November 2026.